

Class - 08 Units - 04 to 07

Unit - 04 Prose Topic: **My Reminiscence** Author: **Rabindranath Tagore**

1. Author & Literary Facts

- Author Profile: **Rabindranath Tagore (1861-1941).**
 - Titles/Professions: He was a **Nobel prize-winning Bengali poet, author, philosopher, artist, and educator.**
 - Famous Work: **He wrote "Gitanjali" in 1912.**
 - **"My Reminiscences"**: This work was **written and published in his fiftieth year**, shortly before he started on a trip to Europe and America for his failing health in 1912.
 - Key Fact: It was during this 1912 trip that Tagore wrote for the first time in the English language for publication.
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2. Core Story Plot & Specific Details

- **The Setting/Location:** The author had returned from his second voyage to England. He went to stay at a river-side villa in Chandernagore (situated on the banks of the Ganges).
- **Family Members Mentioned:** His brother Jyotirindra and his sister-in-law.
- **The Ganges:** Tagore describes the days as "ineffable" and "languid with joy." He considered the river, the Bengal sky, and the south breeze as food and drink, recognizing the "ministrations of a Mother" in them.
- **Modern Changes (Industrialization):** Tagore notes that the small riverside nests were later replaced by mills, which he compares to a dragon (rearing hissing heads, belching black smoke). He notes that modern life brought "hydra-headed unrest."
- **Afternoon Activities:**
 - *Rainy afternoons:* He spent singing old Vaishnava songs to his own tunes, playing the harmonium.
 - *Other afternoons:* Drifting in a boat, with his brother Jyotirindra accompanying him singing on the violin.
 - *Music ragas mentioned:* They started with the Puravi (as the day declined) and reached the Behaga (when the western sky closed and the moon rose).
- **The House ("Moran's Garden"):**
 - The villa was known as 'Moran's Garden'. It had stone-flagged steps leading up from the water to a broad verandah.

- The rooms were not arranged regularly and were on different levels, reached by short flights of stairs.
 - Stained Glass Windows: The big sitting room overlooking the steps had stained glass windows. One pictured a swing hanging from dense foliage with two persons swinging. The other pictured a broad flight of steps leading to a castle-like palace with men and women in festive garb.
 - **The Author's Room:** His room was the topmost room of the house in a round tower with windows opening to every side. He used it for writing poetry.
 - **Literary Reference:** He was busy writing the *Evening Songs* here.
 - **Quote from the text:** "*There, where in the breast of limitless space clouds are laid to sleep, I have built my house for thee, O Poesy!*"
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3. Vocabulary & Glossary

- **ineffable:** beyond expression in words, unspeakable.
- **languid:** moving slowly.
- **plaintive:** sounding sad.
- **ministrations:** the act of helping or caring.
- **wrought:** caused.
- **clustering:** forming a group.
- **belching:** to let air come up.
- **veritable:** more exciting.
- **garb:** clothes.

Book-Back Comprehension Checkpoints:

1. The author speaks about the river Ganges.
 2. The author's brother's name is Jyotirindra.
 3. The moonlight glimmered over the smooth flowing stream.
 4. The topmost room of the house was in a round tower with windows opening to every side.
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4. Word Formation Checkpoints

A. Clipped Words:

- **Definition:** A word formation process which consists of the reduction of a word to one of its parts.
- **Textbook Examples to Memorize:**
 - advertisement - ad
 - automobile - auto

- cabriolet - cab
- examination - exam
- fanatic - fan
- gasoline - gas
- gymnasium - gym
- hamburger - burger
- influenza - flu
- luncheon - lunch
- mathematics - math
- memorandum - memo
- moving picture - movie
- pantaloons - pants
- photograph - photo
- university - varsity
- zoological park - zoo
- telephone - phone
- **Textbook Exercise Answers:** aeroplane (plane), microphone (mike/mic), refrigerator (fridge), kilogram (kilo), cafeteria (cafe).

B. Blended Words (Blends):

- **Definition:** A word formed from parts of two or more other words.
- **Textbook Examples to Memorize:**
 - binary + digit = bit
 - breakfast + lunch = brunch
 - camera + recorder = camcorder
 - electro + execute = electrocute
 - electronic + mail = email
 - mechanics + electronics = mechatronics
 - motor + pedals = moped
 - motor + hotel = motel
 - news + broadcast = newscast
 - smoke + fog = smog
 - Spanish + English = Spanglish
 - vital + amine = vitamin
- **Textbook Exercise Answers:** international + police = interpol, helicopter + pad = helipad, motor + hotel = motel, education + satellite = edusat, electronic + commerce = ecommerce.

5. Idioms & Their Meanings

Food Idioms:

- **Bad Egg:** A dishonest or ill-behaved person.
- **A piece of cake:** A task that can be accomplished very easily.
- **a couch potato:** an idle person.

- **bread and butter:** the necessities.
- **a smart cookie:** a clever person.
- **big cheese:** an important person.
- **Apple of my eye:** someone who is cherished above all others.

Sport Idioms:

- **The ball is in your court:** It is your turn to make a decision.
- **Saved by the bell:** Saved by a last-minute intervention.
- **to strike out:** to fail at something.
- **jump for joy:** happy.
- **on the ball:** fully aware and in control of a situation.
- **front runner:** expected to win or succeed.
- **Drop the ball:** (Idiom used in blank exercise).

Number Idioms:

- **On cloud nine:** Blissfully happy.
- **At sixes and sevens:** Confused or in a state of disorder.
- **one-horse town:** very small town or village.
- **take five:** take a short break.
- **seventh heaven:** very happy about something.
- **perfect ten:** completely perfect.
- **Pieces of eight:** money or wealth

Colours Idioms:

- **Caught red-handed:** to catch someone in the act of doing something.
- **Black sheep:** to be the outcast, odd one out, unlike the others.
- **out of the blue:** randomly, surprisingly.
- **once in a blue moon:** very rarely.
- **gray area:** unclear, undefined.
- **a golden opportunity:** a good chance to get something valuable.
- **Black and blue:** Covered with bruises after being hurt.
- **In black and white:** Clearly in a written or printed form.

Animal Idioms:

- **At a snail's pace:** Moving very slowly.
- **let the cat out of the bag:** reveal a secret.
- **the lion's share:** the biggest part.
- **watch like a hawk:** watching carefully.
- **fish out of water:** very uncomfortable.
- **mad as a hornet:** extremely angry.
- **Wild goose chase:** Looking for something that cannot be found.
- **Cat's meow:** The best or most impressive thing.

6. Writing & Speaking Formats

A. Notice Writing Rules:

- **Definition:** A written or printed announcement put up on display boards in schools or public places to inform people about something that has happened or is about to happen.
- **Language Tone:** Factual, to-the-point, simple, and formal. Personal pronouns shouldn't be used, and the language should not be flowery.
- **Required Components:**
 1. Name of the issuing agency (school/college).
 2. Date of issue/release.
 3. Title/Subject of the Event (What?).
 4. Body (Date, time, duration, place, venue - When and Where?).
 5. Authorized signatory (Name, signature, contact details).

B. Speech Checkpoint:

- The warm-up speaking activity models a two-minute welcome speech for the inauguration of an English Literary Association, featuring a chief guest named Dr. Velavan.

7. Listening Section (General Knowledge Checkpoint)

1. The Nobel Committee has been called a conservative body because: it is conservative in the choice of subjects.
2. In the beginning, the Nobel Committee ignored the great advances in theoretical physics because: they were concerned with the theory and did not suggest its application.
3. Alfred Nobel left his colossal fortune to the cause of progress in human knowledge because he: felt guilty for having invented highly destructive things.

Unit-04 Poem Topic: A Thing of Beauty

Author: John Keats

1. Author & Literary Facts

- **Author Profile:** John Keats.
- **Lifespan:** 1795 – 1821.
- **Literary Era:** He was a British Romantic poet.
- **Profession:** Although he was trained to be a surgeon, Keats decided to devote himself entirely to poetry.

- **His Literary Power:** Keats' secret to swaying and delighting readers lies in his gift for perceiving the world and living his moods and aspirations in terms of language.

2. Poem Background & Origin

- **Original Work:** "A Thing of Beauty" is an excerpt from Keats' larger poem titled 'Endymion: A Poetic Romance'.
- **The Legend:** The poem is based on a Greek legend.
- **Key Characters & Places in the Legend:**
 - **Endymion:** A beautiful young shepherd and poet.
 - **Location:** He lived on Mount Latmos.
 - **Cynthia:** The Moon Goddess. Endymion had a vision of her.
- **The Journey:** The enchanted youth (Endymion) resolved to seek Cynthia out, wandering away through the forest and down under the sea.

3. Glossary & Vocabulary

- **bower (n):** shelter under the shade of trees.
- **wreathing (v):** cover, surround, encircle something.
- **pall (n):** covering.
- **rills (n):** clear stream.
- **sprinkling (v):** falling in fine drops.

4. Textbook Evaluation Checkpoints (Direct Exam Questions)

1. According to the poet, a thing of beauty is _____.
○ Answer: **a joy forever.**
2. Beautiful things never "pass in to nothingness" means that they _____.
○ Answer: **never fade away.**
3. "Will keep a bower quiet for us" means _____.
○ Answer: **will give us peace and calm.**
4. Of all the unhealthy means _____.
○ Answer: **ill-health.**
5. The sun, moon, trees, old and young are the things that _____.
○ Answer: **remove the pall of gloom from our lives.**

5. Poetic Devices & Figures of Speech

A. Alliteration:

- **Definition:** Alliteration is the repetition of the same consonant letters or similar sounds at the beginning of words in a set or series of words.
- **Textbook Examples to Memorize:**
 - wild wind
 - curious clock
 - splendid scholar
 - memorable moments
 - creepy crawlies

B. Imagery:

- **Definition:** Imagery is the way that a writer helps readers visualize or see in their minds what is being described.
- **Textbook Examples to Memorize:**
 - During Christmas the house smells like a chocolate brownie.
 - The kitten's fur is like a velvet coat.
 - The mountain was spewing and spitting the smoke.
 - The autumn leaves formed a blanket on the grass.

Unit-04 Supplementary Topic: Crossing the River Author: Manoj Das

1. Author & Literary Facts

- **Author Profile:** Manoj Das (born 1934) is an award-winning Indian author who writes in Odia and English.
- **Awards & Recognitions:**
 - **Saraswati Samman:** Awarded in the year 2000.
 - **Padma Shri:** Awarded in 2001 (the fourth highest Civilian Award in India) for his contribution to Literature & Education.
 - **Sahitya Akademi Award Fellowship:** Kendra Sahitya Akademi bestowed its highest award upon him.
- **Spiritual Life:** His deeper quest led him to mysticism, and he has been an inmate of Sri Aurobindo Ashram in Puducherry since 1963.

2. Core Characters & Story Plot

- **The Celebrated Pundit:** He was an eloquent speaker who had many disciples and admirers. He gave discourses on God, Truth, and complex matters, keeping hundreds of people spellbound. However, his knowledge was mere theory without true faith.
- **Moti (The Milkmaid):** A poor, faithful, and innocent (naive) woman. She felt it was a great privilege to serve the Pundit and stood behind the audience during his discourses, believing he was very near to God.
- **The Landlord:** Lived on the other side of the river and commissioned Moti to supply a tumblerful of milk to the Pundit every morning.
- **The Conflict:** The Pundit needed milk at least an hour before sunrise for a month to perform a specific ritual/vow. Moti arrived late the first day because the boatman refused to ply the ferry boat in the darkness while the river was in spate (flooded).
- **The "Secret":** The Pundit jocularly (jokingly) told Moti that mystics say one can cross the ocean of life simply by uttering the name of Vishnu.

- **The Climax:** At the end of the month, the Pundit asked Moti to thank the boatman. Moti revealed she didn't use the boat; she just uttered the name of Vishnu, making the flooded river ankle-deep for her.
- **The Conclusion:** Thinking she was kidding, the Pundit followed her on tiptoe the next dawn. He watched her pay obeisance to the river and walk across the water with ease. The Pundit almost fainted upon seeing this miracle.
- **The Moral:** The story draws a contrast between scholarship (knowledge that remains a mere theory) and innocence (knowledge that works through complete faith and surrender to the Lord).

3. Glossary & Vocabulary

- **prostrated (v):** falling flat on the ground as a mark of respect.
- **eloquent (adj):** fluent, expressive.
- **discourse (n):** discussion, spoken communication.
- **spellbound (v):** awestruck, captivating.
- **resolved (v):** firmly determined to do something.
- **ritual (n):** a religious or solemn ceremony.
- **enthusiastically (adv):** interest, eager enjoyment.
- **apologetically (adv):** shows regretful acknowledgment.
- **spate (n):** rush, run, flood.
- **jocularly (adv):** humorous, funny.
- **pious (adj):** spiritual, devoutly religious, dedicated.
- **guffaw (n):** a loud and hearty laugh.
- **naivety (n):** lack of experience, innocence.
- **dawn (n):** day break, early morning.
- **intrigued (v):** arouse the curiosity of, fascinate, attract.
- **obeisance (n):** respect, reverence, honour.

4. Textbook Evaluation Checkpoints (Direct Exam Questions)

A. Match the Following:

1. ritual - vow.
2. pundit - eloquent discourse.
3. Moti - faithful.
4. ferry - passenger boat.
5. audience - spell bound.
6. secret - to cross the river easily.

B. Fill in the Blanks:

1. Pundit had many disciples and admirers.
2. Moti is a poor milkmaid.
3. The milkmaid discharged her duties faithfully.
4. Moti feels it as a privilege to serve the great pundit.

5. The pundit was an eloquent speaker.
6. Moti gave the milk at dawn enthusiastically.

C. Identify the Speaker:

1. "But I apply the secret!" - **Speaker: Moti.**
2. "Tell the boatman how pleased I am with him." - **Speaker: The Pundit.**

5. Mental Ability & Logical Reasoning ("Steps to Success")

A. Sentence Completion:

- **Question:** As I _____ in the rain for the bus to arrive, it appeared as _____ it would not arrive, _____ it took all my patience.
- **Answer Option:** c. waited, though, till.

B. Analogies (Find the 2nd pair similar to the 1st):

1. Bread : Yeast :: Curd : ?

- **Answer:** b) bacteria. (Logic: Yeast is the microorganism used to make bread; bacteria is the microorganism used to make curd).

2. Fungi : Fungus :: Species : ?

- **Answer:** d) species. (Logic: Fungus is singular and Fungi is plural. The word 'Species' is both singular and plural).

3. Throw : Worth :: Tide : ?

- **Answer:** c) edit. (Logic: This is an anagram. The letters in T-H-R-O-W rearrange to form W-O-R-T-H. The letters in T-I-D-E rearrange to form E-D-I-T).

4. Lion : Forest :: Otter : ?

- **Answer:** b) water. (Logic: A lion's primary habitat is the forest; an otter's primary habitat is the water).

Unit- 05 - Prose

Topic: Being Safe

1. Core Story Plot & Characters

- **Characters:** Prasanth, his Grandpa, and his friends (Sundar, Ravi, Peter, Jaffer, Mani, Gandhi, Murthy, Sam, Devi).
- **Setting:** Prasanth lives with his parents in Tiruchirappalli and visits his grandparents in Nagathi, a river island in Thanjavur District during summer.
- **Geographical Feature:** The village is evergreen because the river water bifurcates (divides into two) and merges again, forming the island village.
- **Grandpa's Profile:** He is a retired central government employee who has travelled to many parts of India, and his knowledge amuses Prasanth.

2. Safety Rules & Checkpoints

A. Road Safety:

- Always walk on the right-hand side of the road, against the traffic, so you can see the approaching vehicles.
- Before crossing, you must look right, left, and then right again.
- Walk in a line one behind the other, not in groups.
- Never use a cell phone while walking on the road.

B. Sun Safety:

- Do not roam in the hot sun between 10 A.M. and 3 P.M..
- Apply sunscreen 15 to 20 minutes before going out to avoid sunburn.
- Sunstroke Symptoms: If the body cannot cool itself fast enough, you may get a sunstroke. Symptoms include feeling hot, headache, feeling giddy, or nauseating.
- "Street Smart": Playing outdoor games gives you experience to deal with potential difficulties and dangers, making you "street smart".

C. Home & Medicine Safety:

- Do not play with knives and scissors.
- Medicines, pills, and syrups should be kept in a locked cabinet, out of sight and reach of children.
- Pills should be kept in their original containers, and leftover pills must always be disposed of.
- Items like fertilizers, antifreeze, makeup sets, poisonous items, and hazardous automotive/gardening products must be kept locked and secured.
- Every household must have a first aid kit containing emergency instructions.

D. Cyber Safety:

- Mobile phones should only be used in the presence of adults.
- To be cyber safe, never post personal information, photos, or vacation plans on social media.

3. Vocabulary & Glossary

A. Glossary Words:

- **bifurcates (v)**: divide into two separate parts.
- **amuses (v)**: to make someone laugh or smile.
- **vacation (n)**: holiday.
- **merges (v)**: join together.
- **scorching (v)**: extremely hot.

- **sunscreen (n):** a cream or lotion rubbed on the skin to protect it from the sun.
- **exhausted (v):** feeling tired.
- **sunstroke (n):** unconscious or heatstroke brought about by excessive exposure to the sun.
- **giddy (adj):** having a sensation of falling down.
- **nauseated (adj):** sickening, stomach-turning.
- **street smart (adj):** an experience to deal with potential difficulties and dangers.
- **fertilizer (n):** chemical or natural substance added to land to increase its fertility.
- **antifreeze (n):** a liquid that can be added to water to lower the freezing point.
- **hazardous (adj):** risky; dangerous.
- **emergency (n):** often dangerous situation requiring immediate action.

B. Synonym Exercise Checkpoints:

- **exhausted - tired.**
- **antique - ancient.**
- **hazardous - dangerous.**
- **emergency - crisis.**

C. Antonym Exercise Checkpoints:

- **ancestral x modern.**
- **safely x unsafely.**
- **stored x consumed.**
- **provides x withholds.**
- **latest x outdated.**

4. Grammar & Language Checkpoints

A. Homonyms:

- **Definition:** Two or more words having the same spelling and pronunciation but different meanings and origins.
- **Textbook Examples to Memorize:**
 - **address:** location (This is her address) / **address:** to speak to (She addressed the open-air meeting).
 - **band:** a musical group / **band:** a ring to tie hair.
 - **bat:** mammal / **bat:** an implement used to hit a ball.
 - **right:** correct / **right:** direction.
 - **bright:** very smart or intelligent / **bright:** filled with light.
 - **express:** something done fast / **express:** convey.
 - **kind:** type / **kind:** caring.
 - **well:** in good health / **well:** water resource.

B. Phrasal Verbs:

- **Definition:** A verb made up of a main verb together with an adverb or a preposition, or both. *Example:* "Catch on" means to understand.
- **Textbook Meanings to Memorize:**
 - **call on (somebody):** visit somebody.
 - **call back:** to return a phone call.
 - **get rid of:** to eliminate.
 - **keep on:** to continue doing something.
 - **kick off:** to begin, start (e.g., The rugby match kicked off).
 - **look after:** take care of.
 - **Other Phrasal Verbs Practiced:** look into, give up, put off, get on, take off, put up with, take over, go through.

C. Expressing Likes and Dislikes (Speaking Skill):

- **Phrases for Likes:** I like, I love, I enjoy, I'm keen on, I live for, I'm fond of, I'm crazy about.
- **Phrases for Dislikes:** I don't like, I dislike, I hate, I loathe, I don't really care for, I'm not a huge fan of, I can't bear.

5. Textbook Evaluation Checkpoints (Direct Exam Questions)

A. True or False:

1. Prasanth had gone to bring coffee for his friends. - False.
2. Grandpa was so angry seeing Prasanth's friends. - False.
3. Teacher had taught the children about road safety. - True.

B. Fill in the Blanks:

1. They had come to play under the shade of big Neem tree.
2. We should put on sunscreen to avoid sunburn.
3. Sunstroke is a more serious health-related illness.
4. Mani's mother had instructed him not to roam in the sunlight between 10 A.M. and 3 P.M..
5. Street smart means an experience to deal with potential difficulties and dangers.

C. Multiple Choice Questions:

1. Children should not play with knives and scissors.
2. Grandpa got a call from his old friend (Raghu).
3. Medicine should be kept in a locked cabinet.
4. Hazardous automotive and gardening products should be secured.
5. Every household should have a First aid kit.

1. Author & Poem Facts

- **Author Profile:** The poem is written by **Enid Blyton**.
- **Core Theme:** The poem is about the effects of noise pollution (specifically from fireworks) on animals, narrated from the perspective of a frightened pet dog.

2. Core Story Plot & Specific Details

- **The Cause of Fear:** The dog is terrified by the loud "Bang!" of fireworks, which he describes as "guns shooting in the dark".
- **The Plea:** The dog begs his **Mistress and Master** to help him and let him in.
- **Physical Signs of Fear:** The dog describes his fear physically: his **tail is down**, his **ears are flat**, and he is **trembling** outside the door. He feels abandoned and wonders if they love him anymore.
- **The Relief:** Once the door opens, the dog rushes through to the warm and bright inside.
- **The Hiding Place:** He licks his mistress's hand and then slips behind the **couch** to hide and crouch until the bangs are over.
- **The Resolution:** Once the noise stops, the dog promises to return to his **kennel** and guard the house safely all night because his owners understood his fright.

3. Glossary & Vocabulary Checkpoints

- **bang (n):** a sudden loud, sharp noise.
- **yelp (v):** a short, sharp cry, especially of pain or alarm.
- **trembling (v):** to shake in fear.
- **rushing (v):** moving hastily.
- **couch (n):** a type of high bed / sofa.
- **crouch (v):** to lie close to the ground with the knees bent.
- **kennel (n):** a small shelter for dogs.
- **fright (n):** panic.

4. Poetic Devices & Figures of Speech

A. Personification:

- **Definition:** Personification is a figure of speech in which a thing, an idea, or an animal is given a human attribute.
- **Textbook Examples to Memorize:**

- The Sun **smiled** down upon them.
- Justice is **blind**.
- The wind **howled** in the night.
- The moon **played hide and seek** with the clouds.
- The city **never sleeps** at night.
- The boat **danced** in the puddle.
- The flowers **nodded** their heads.
- The thunder **grumbled**.
- The lightning **danced** all over the sky.
- The **iron hands** of Death.
- The popcorn **leapt** out of the bowl.

B. Personification Exercise (Direct Exam Questions):

1. **What is being personified in the sentence- 'The full moon peeped through partial clouds'?**
 - *Answer:* The full moon.
2. **Which of the following is an example of personification?**
 - *Answer:* **c) The delicious smell of chocolates invited me to eat them.**
3. **Personification is_____.**
 - *Answer:* **c) giving human attributes to non-human objects.**

C. Rhyming Words & Rhyme Scheme:

- *Stanza Analysis:* "Mistress, Master, hear me yelp, / I'm out-of-doors, I want your help. / Let me in-oh, LET ME IN / Before those fireworks begin"
 - **Rhyme Scheme: a a b b** (yelp-a, help-a, IN-b, begin-b).
- *Identify the Rhyming Pairs:* "To shoot again I can't bear that; / My tail is down, my ears are flat, / I'm trembling here outside the door, / Oh, don't you love me anymore?"
 - **Rhyming Words: that & flat; door & anymore.**
- *Textbook Matching Checkpoint:*
 - **Hark** rhymes with **dark**.
 - **Too** rhymes with **do**.
 - **Yelp** rhymes with **help**.
 - **Grand** rhymes with **hand**.
 - **Couch** rhymes with **crouch**.
 - **Night** rhymes with **fright**.

5. General Knowledge & Science Facts ("Do You Know")

- **The Dog Whistle:** Also known as a **silent whistle** or **Galton's whistle**.
- **How it Works:** It emits sound in the **ultrasonic range**. Humans cannot hear it, but animals like dogs and domestic cats can. It is primarily used in their training.
- **The Inventor:** It was invented by **Francis Galton** in the year **1876**.

- **The Publication:** Francis Galton mentioned it in his book titled ***"Inquiries into Human Faculty and its Development"***, where he described experiments testing the range of frequencies various animals (like house cats) could hear.

6. Textbook Comprehension Checkpoints (Direct Exam Questions)

1. **Why was the dog frightened?**
 - The dog was frightened by the loud banging noise of the fireworks being shot in the dark.
2. **Whom did the dog ask for help?**
 - The dog asked its Master and Mistress for help.
3. **What did the dog do when the door opened?**
 - The dog rushed inside, enjoyed the warmth, and licked its mistress's hand in gratitude.
4. **Where did the dog hide himself?**
 - The dog hid himself by crouching behind the couch.
5. **Where will the dog go when the firework stops?**
 - The dog will go back to his kennel to guard the house safely all night.

Unit-05 - Supplementary Topic: When Instinct Works Author: Anna Sewell

1. Author & Text Facts

- **Author Profile:** Anna Sewell, an English writer.
- **Famous Work:** The children's classic ***Black Beauty***.
- **Original Audience:** Although it came to be treated as a children's book, it was originally meant for **those who took care of horses**.
- **Core Theme:** The story talks about kindness, sympathy, and understanding in the treatment of horses.
- **Main Concept:** God gave people brains to think things out, but gave animals a **special knowledge/instinct** that is much quicker to respond to danger, which has often saved the lives of men.

2. Characters & Their Roles

- **Black Beauty (The Narrator):** A horse who uses its animal instinct to save its master and John from drowning. It is described as "fresh" and well-brought-up (it did not run away when frightened).
- **The Master:** The owner of Black Beauty. He goes on a long business journey. He is gentle, driving carefully through floods, and acknowledges the special instinct God gave to animals.

- **John:** The caretaker/driver who harnesses Black Beauty. He calms the horse's nerves during the storm, tries to lead it across the bridge, and shares many stories about how dogs and horses save lives.
- **Mistress:** The Master's wife who runs out to greet them upon their late return, worried they had an accident.
- **The Toll Gate Man:** Warns the travellers twice; first in the morning about the rising river, and later at night by flashing a torch like a madman to stop them from crossing the broken bridge.

3. Core Story Plot & Specific Details

- **The Journey Begins:** It was an **autumn** morning. The master had to go on a long journey for business, so John harnessed Black Beauty to the **new cart**.
- **The First Toll Gate Crossing:** They came to a toll gate at the entrance to a **low wooden bridge**. The bridge had good **sturdy rails**. The toll gate man warned that the river was rising fast. In one low part of the road, the water was halfway up to the horse's **knees**.
- **The Town:** The Master's business kept him a long time. They started for home late in the afternoon.
- **The Storm & The Tree:** While passing through a wood, the wind made a terrible rushing sound. Suddenly, with a groan and a splitting sound, an **Oak tree** was torn up by the roots and crashed across the road.
- **The Alternate Route:** Because the road was blocked, John suggested going back to "**four cross ways**", which would add about **six miles** to the journey before reaching the wooden bridge again.
- **The Broken Bridge:** As they touched the first part of the bridge in the dark, Black Beauty made a "**dead stop**". The Master gave him a **touch of the whip**, and then a **sharp snap of the whip**, but the horse refused to go forward.
- **The Rescue:** The man at the tollgate on the other side ran out **flashing a torch**, shouting that the bridge was **broken in the middle**, carried away by the flood.
- **The Reward:** After returning safely, John took Black Beauty to the stable, gave him a **good supper**, and provided a **really thick bed of straw**.

4. Glossary & Vocabulary

- **harnessed (v):** tied the horse to a cart using strips of leather and metal fittings.
- **tollgate (n):** a gate across a road or bridge at which travellers must stop and pay.
- **sturdy (adj):** strong.
- **groan (n):** deep sound.
- **bridle (n):** a set of leather straps tied around the neck of a horse to control it.

- **instinct (n):** an innate typically fixed pattern of behavior in animals in response to certain stimuli.
- **a dead stop (n):** complete and sudden halt.

5. Textbook Evaluation Checkpoints (Direct Exam Questions)

A. Choose the best option (MCQs):

1. The season mentioned in the story is **b) autumn**.
2. In one low part of the road the **c) water** was halfway up to black beauty's knees.
3. The bridge was broken in the **c) middle**.
4. The instinct in **b) animals** had often saved the lives of men.
5. Black beauty dared not move even to the sharp snap of the **c) whip**.

B. Match the Following:

1. **Man at the toll gate** - flashing a torch.
2. **Bridge** - sturdy rail.
3. **John** - had many stories to tell.
4. **Black beauty** - wise.
5. **Animals** - have special knowledge.

C. Fill in the Blanks:

1. Suddenly an **oak** tree came crashing down and fell right in front of us.
2. Just then, the man at the toll gate on the other side ran out, **flashing** a torch.
3. He told that the bridge had just broken due to the **flood**.
4. Even when John tried to **lead** him forward Beauty did not move.
5. We were saved because Beauty had known that something was **wrong** with the bridge.

6. Mental Ability & Logical Reasoning ("Step to Success")

1. **Question:** If Violet = Green, Green = Red, Red = Brown, Brown = Orange, Orange = Yellow, Yellow = Blue, and Blue = Indigo, what is the colour of human blood?
 - *Logic:* Human blood is physically Red. In this code language, Red is called "Brown".
 - *Answer: e. Brown.*
2. **Question:** If Pen = Eraser, Eraser = Book, Book = Scale, Scale = Sharpener, Sharpener = Duster, and Duster = Table, what object is used to clean the blackboard?
 - *Logic:* A Duster is used to clean a blackboard. In this language, Duster means "Table".
 - *Answer: c. Table.*

3. **Question:** If Bread = Butter, Butter = Milk, Milk = Shirt, Shirt = Shoe, Shoe = Bicycle, Bicycle = Watch, Watch = Aeroplane, and Aeroplane = Ship, what indicates time?
- *Logic:* Time is indicated by a Watch. In this language, Watch is called "Aeroplane".
 - *Answer:* **e. Aeroplane.**

7. Civic Rules & Grammar Context (ICT Corner)

- **Connecting to Self (Do's and Don'ts):** The textbook highlights important safety rules through images. Students should avoid talking on the phone while driving, travelling on the footboard of a bus, playing near roads/zebra crossings, and taking selfies on railway tracks. They *should* wear a seatbelt while driving.
- **ICT Corner - Grammar Focus:** The lesson explicitly directs students to practice **If Conditional Clauses**.
- **Note on Adjectives (Visualized in ICT Images):** The images in the ICT corner specifically outline the rules for **Irregular Comparatives and Superlatives**. Aspirants should memorize these irregular forms:
 - bad - worse - worst
 - far (distance) - farther - farthest
 - far (extent) - further - furthest
 - good - better - best
 - little - less - least
 - many/much - more - most
- **Expressing Similarities:** Use the structure "... as + adjective + as ..."
(e.g., Mike is *as intelligent as* Nancy).

Unit-06 - Prose

Topic: Friendship

1. Core Story Plot & Character Checkpoints

- **Characters:**
 - **Vetri:** A once-successful businessman who ran **Vetri Constructions**.
 - **Asif:** Vetri's childhood friend who became the Managing Director (MD) of a business in Chennai,.
- **Background & Location:**
 - Vetri and Asif lived in the beautiful village of **Keelakudi**, near **Coimbatore**.
 - They studied in a middle school located on the **outskirts** of the village.
- **The Friendship:**

- Their friendship began on the very **first day of school** when Vetri started crying after his parents dropped him off. Asif consoled him with a **chocolate** and invited him to play.
- Despite a quarrel between their families that caused their families to stop talking to each other, the boys remained good friends.
- They had a healthy competition in studies, and their friendship continued until the **tenth standard**, after which Vetri moved to Coimbatore and Asif settled in Chennai.
- **Vetri's Struggle:**
 - Vetri Constructions built shopping complexes, houses, and apartments in and around Coimbatore.
 - After his father's death, Vetri's brothers demanded to split the wealth. Vetri took loans to run his company but couldn't repay them, forcing him to sell all his properties.
 - Living in a very small house and working a regular job, he longed to start a new construction firm. His wife suggested he ask Asif for help.
- **The Meeting in Chennai:**
 - Vetri hesitated but eventually travelled to Chennai and went to Asif's office,.
 - The security stopped him, and the receptionist asked for his details. Asif saw Vetri on the **CCTV camera** and immediately came out to greet him with a pat on the back.
 - Vetri was **dumbfound** and lied that he was in Chennai to attend a friend's wedding.
 - Asif took Vetri to his home for lunch, where Vetri was surprised to learn that everyone in Asif's family already knew about him. Asif dropped him at the railway station in the evening.
- **The Resolution:**
 - Two days later, Vetri received a call from Asif's office stating that MD Mr. Asif had **assigned a project** to him and requested him to come to Chennai.

2. Glossary & Vocabulary

- **complexes:** consisting of many different and connected parts.
- **demanded:** ask authoritatively.
- **establish:** set up on a firm and permanent basis.
- **decided:** having clear opinion.
- **boarded:** get on or into a vehicle.
- **consoled:** comfort someone at the time of grief.
- **exchanged:** give something and receive something.
- **competition:** an event or contest.
- **affected:** cause a change in someone or something.
- **nervously:** in an anxious or uneasy manner.
- **astounded:** shocked or greatly surprised.
- **hesitatingly:** to be reluctant or wait to act because of fear.

- **dumbfound:** speechless.
- **dropped:** leave a person at a place.

3. Grammar & Language Checkpoints

A. Commonly Confused Words: Aspirants must strictly memorize these definitions and their specific spellings/sounds.

- **Advice vs. Advise:**
 - *Advice* (noun) has an /s/ sound and means a "recommendation regarding a decision".
 - *Advise* (verb) has a /z/ sound and means "to recommend".
- **Complement vs. Compliment:**
 - *Complement:* It is a part of something.
 - *Compliment:* It is a nice thing to say.
- **Empathy vs. Sympathy:**
 - *Empathy:* The ability to understand another person's perspective or feelings.
 - *Sympathy:* A feeling of sorrow for someone else's suffering.
- **Inquiry vs. Enquiry:**
 - *Inquiry:* The standard **American English** spelling.
 - *Enquiry:* The **British** spelling. Both mean a request for information.
- **Stationary vs. Stationery:**
 - *Stationary:* Means not moving.
 - *Stationery:* Refers to writing and other office materials.
- **Effect vs. Affect:**
 - *Effect:* A result or an outcome (usually a noun).
 - *Affect:* To have an impression, influence, or effect on something (usually a verb).
- **Lie vs. Lay:**
 - *Lie:* Means to be in a flat position on a surface.
 - *Lay:* Means to place something down flat.
- **Rise vs. Raise:**
 - *Rise:* Get up / go to a higher position.
 - *Raise:* Elevate something to a higher position.

Textbook Fill-in-the-Blanks Checkpoint:

1. The sugar had a negative **effect** on the science experiment.
2. I am going to **lie** down for an hour.
3. The gas prices continue to **rise**.
4. She always gives me good **advice**.
5. The war had no **effect** on oil prices.

B. Anagrams & Antigrams:

- **Anagram Definition:** A word or phrase formed by rearranging the letters of another word or phrase.
 - *Textbook Examples:* are–ear, note–tone, care–race, won–now, god–dog, earth–heart, meat–team, slip–lips.
- **Antigram Definition:** An anagram which gives the **opposite meaning** to the original word or a phrase.
 - *Textbook Examples:* santa–Satan, united–untied, harmfulness–Harmless fun.

4. Textbook Evaluation Checkpoints (Direct Exam Questions)

A. Multiple Choice Questions:

1. Vetri went to Asif's **b) office**.
2. Vetri came to Chennai to visit his **b) friend**.
3. Asif saw his friend on the **a) CCTV**.

B. True or False:

1. Vetri lived in Keelakudi. - **True**.
2. There was a middle school in the middle of the village Keelakudi. - **False** (*It was on the outskirts*),.
3. Vetri and Asif were not so good in studies. - **False** (*They were always good in studies*),.
4. Vetri never visited Chennai. - **True** (*Until this trip*),.
5. Asif was a businessman. - **True**.

C. Synonyms (Contextual Meaning):

1. Vetri *constructed* a bungalow - **b) built**.
2. Asif *consoled* Vetri with the chocolate - **a) comforted**.
3. I am living in the *outskirts* of the village - **a) border**.
4. Asif *quarreled* with his friend - **a) fought**.
5. He stood *astounded* - **c) shocked**.

D. Antonyms:

1. Vetri's wife replied *angrily* x **a) calmly**.
2. The vegetables look *fresh* x **b) dull**.
3. Vetri had a *strong* will to start a new business x **c) weak**.
4. Vetri was *surprised* by his friend x **b) expected**.
5. He spoke *nervously* x **b) confident**.

5. Additional Writing & Speaking Concepts

A. Descriptive Words (Synonym Groupings): The text categorizes descriptive adjectives. These are highly useful for matching questions.

- **Large:** Enormous, Gigantic, Huge, Massive, Tremendous.

- **Small:** Miniature, Minute, Petite, Tiny, Slight.
- **Good:** Fantastic, Excellent, Amazing, Wonderful, Marvellous.
- **Happy:** Joyful, Delighted, Thrilled, Glad, Pleased.

B. Guidelines for Filling Forms:

- Forms are used for opening a bank account, booking tickets, or applying to institutions.
- **Crucial Rules:** Fill all entries in English/Regional language as required, use **capital letters**, write legibly, do not overwrite or score out, give only required details, and do not forget to sign or get attestations.

Unit-06 - Poem **Topic:** Lessons in Life **Authors:** Bridgette Bryant & Daniel Ho

1. Poem Themes & Summary

- **Friendship:** Having a friend is compared to **planting a flower**. To make it bloom, one must show love and kindness.
- **Coexistence:** We must be aware that as we walk on this planet, even the **tiniest creature needs room** to live.
- **Gratitude:** Lessons in life are not simple, and nothing you are given will ever come free. Even the **smallest of gifts deserves a "thank you"**.
- **Mutual Respect:** The poem emphasizes mutual respect with the lines, "I respect you and you respect / I think of you and you think of me",.
- **Importance of Every Individual:** Everyone on the planet is important and matters. Being forgotten makes people feel sad.
- **No Shaming:** The poem advises to let no one shame you or make you feel bad because you make a difference.

2. Glossary & Vocabulary

- **kindness (n):** humble.
- **bloom (v):** come into.
- **tiniest (adj):** smallest.
- **forgotten (v):** out of mind.
- **deserves (v):** be qualified for.

3. Figures of Speech

A. Simile:

- **Definition:** A figure of speech in which two unlike things are compared using the connecting words '**like**' or '**as**'.
- *Poem Example:* "**Having a friend is like planting a flower.**".
- **Textbook Examples to Memorize & Their Meanings:**

- **as blind as a bat:** means that someone is not willing to notice.
- **like peas in a pod:** means that two people are quite similar.
- **as wise as an owl:** refers to someone who is very smart or knowledgeable.
- **quiet like a mule:** refers to someone who is calm.
- **as brave as a lion:** refers to someone who is very brave or courageous.
- *Other Similes noted in exercises:* "as fast as the wind", "as smart as a fox", "Life is like a chocolate box", "The bus is slow as a snail",,.

B. Metaphor:

- **Definition:** An implied meaning. Unlike similes, metaphors **directly state the comparison** between two things that are in no way similar, without using 'like' or 'as'.
- **Textbook Examples to Memorize & Their Meanings:**
 - **My father was boiling mad:** implies that he was very angry.
 - **She is the apple of my eye:** implies that she is too dear to me.
 - **Your brain is a computer:** implies that your brain is smart and quick.
 - **Her voice is music to his ears:** implies that her voice makes him feel happy.
 - **The given task was a breeze:** implies that the task was not difficult.
- *Exercise Checkpoints (Direct Exam Questions):*
 - Which of the given options is a Metaphor? - **c) His words are pearls of wisdom.**
 - Identify the Metaphor in the sentence: "Her hair is always a **rat's nest** in the morning".
 - Another famous metaphor mentioned: "**The world is a stage**".

4. English Literature General Knowledge Fact

- **William Shakespeare** invented over **1700 words** that have become very common today.
- **How he invented them:** He achieved this by changing nouns into verbs, changing verbs into adjectives, connecting words that were never before used together, adding prefixes and suffixes, and devising wholly original words.

5. Parallel Reading (Supplementary Poem)

- **Poem Title:** A Time to Talk.
- **Author:** Robert Frost.
- **Core Snapshot:** A speaker stops his work of hoeing the mellow ground, leaving his hoe blade-end up, to walk over to the stone wall for a friendly visit when a friend calls to him from the road.

1. Core Story Plot & Factual Details

- **The Setting / Location:** The story takes place in **Rio do Sul** in **south Brazil**.
- **The Protagonist (César):** A homeless man who lived on the streets and often sacrificed his own food (forgoing his own meals) to feed the stray dogs around him.
- **The Incident:** César arrived at the emergency room of a hospital to seek treatment and medication for a disease he was battling.
- **Time of Admission:** He arrived at the hospital at about **3 A.M.**
- **The Companions:** He was accompanied by a gang of **four dogs** who waited anxiously at the entrance of the hospital for their master.
- **The Nurse:** A nurse named **Cris Mamprim** and her colleagues witnessed the dogs' incredible loyalty.
- **The Social Media Post:** Mamprim clicked a picture of César with his dogs and posted the story on **Facebook**.
- **The Climax:** Not wanting to keep them apart, the hospital staff let the dogs inside after giving César his medication, and they even offered César some food. César ate some and **saved a bit to give to the dogs later**.
- **The Departure:** An hour later, César left the hospital safely with his four dogs trailing behind him, happily wagging their tails.

2. Glossary & Vocabulary Checkpoints

- **boomerang (n):** coming back. (*Context: His kindness came back to him like a boomerang*).
- **medication (n):** medicine/treatment.
- **incredible (adj):** unbelievable.
- **anticipating (v):** expecting.
- **canines (n):** dogs.
- **trailing (v):** following behind.
- **reciprocal (adj):** given, felt, or done in return.
- **kins (n):** family or relatives (*Context: César had no kins to turn to*).

3. Textbook Evaluation Checkpoints (Direct Exam Questions)

A. Comprehension Short Answers:

1. **Who is the protagonist of this story?** - César, the homeless man.
2. **Where did this story happen?** - Rio do Sul in south Brazil.
3. **When was he admitted in the hospital?** - At about 3 A.M.
4. **Who accompanied him to the hospital?** - Four faithful stray dogs.

5. **Where did the nurse post this story?** - On Facebook.
6. **What did Cesar do when he was offered food by the nurses?** - He ate some and saved a bit to give to the dogs later.

4. Mental Ability & Logical Reasoning ("Step to Success")

Base Logic: Number the alphabet according to their position (A=1, B=2, C=3 ... Z=26).

- **Question 1:** In a certain code language, if BUG = 30 and ALMS = 45 then CADET =?
 - *Logic (Direct Sum):* B(2) + U(21) + G(7) = 30. A(1) + L(12) + M(13) + S(19) = 45.
 - *Solving CADET:* C(3) + A(1) + D(4) + E(5) + T(20) = 33.
 - *Answer: c. 33* (Note: The sum is 33, making option 'c' the correct choice).
- **Question 2:** In a certain code language, if INFER = 25 and JERSEY = 28, then CHOICE =?
 - *Logic (Sum and Reverse):*
 - INFER: I(9) + N(14) + F(6) + E(5) + R(18) = 52. Reverse the digits of 52 - **25**.
 - JERSEY: J(10) + E(5) + R(18) + S(19) + E(5) + Y(25) = 82. Reverse the digits of 82 - **28**.
 - *Solving CHOICE:* C(3) + H(8) + O(15) + I(9) + C(3) + E(5) = 43. Reverse the digits of 43 - **34**.
 - *Answer: b. 34.*
- **Question 3:** In a certain code language, EGG is 577 and ICE is 935 then what is 8945?
 - *Logic (Direct Letter-to-Number Substitution):* E(5), G(7), G(7) = 577. I(9), C(3), E(5) = 935.
 - *Solving 8945:* 8=H, 9=I, 4=D, 5=E - HIDE.
 - *Answer: a. HIDE.*
- **Question 4:** In a certain code language, YSMIR is TNHDM and VPJHN is QKECI then GKTZO is _____?
 - *Logic (Minus 5 Shift):* Each letter is shifted backward by 5 places in the alphabet.
 - Y(25) - 5 = T(20); S(19) - 5 = N(14), etc.
 - *Solving GKTZO:* G(7) - 5 = B(2); K(11) - 5 = F(6); T(20) - 5 = O(15); Z(26) - 5 = U(21); O(15) - 5 = J(10).
 - *Result:* B-F-O-U-J.
 - *Answer: b. BFOUJ.*

1. Core Story Plot & Factual Details

- **Characters:** Gladin, his sister Rani, and their parents.
- **The Internet as a Tool:** Gladin asks his mother how a **screw gauge** works, and she advises him to browse the internet, calling it a great tool to gather information and gain knowledge. Gladin uses it for his **science project**.
- **The Cyber Threat:** Rani is frightened because she is being threatened by an **online predator**. The predator knows her name, address, and age.
- **Safety Guidelines for Children:**
 - Do not give your name, address, or telephone number to strangers.
 - Keep personal details secret in the internet.
 - Rani's father advises her not to respond to the predator's messages. If the predator continues to bother her, they will report it to the **cyber police**.
- **Mobile Addiction & Side Effects:** Too much of anything is good for nothing. The text explicitly lists the following serious physical and mental problems caused by mobile addiction:
 - Headache, weakened eyesight, and sleep disorders.
 - Depression, stress, social isolation, and aggressive behaviour.
 - Financial problems, ruined relationships, and no or low professional growth.
- **Conclusion:** We cannot ignore the benefits of the internet and mobile phones, but we must strictly limit their usage.

2. Glossary & Vocabulary Checkpoints

A. Textbook Glossary:

- **screw gauge (n):** measuring tool.
- **browse (v):** to scan, to casually look through in order to find items of interest.
- **frightened (v):** scared.
- **online predator (n):** someone who sexually exploits a child over the internet.
- **bother (v):** to disturb or annoy.
- **cyber (adj):** relating to or characteristic of the culture of computers, information technology, and virtual reality.
- **aggressive (adj):** prone to behave in a way that involves attacking or arguing.
- **beneficial (adj):** helpful or good to something or someone.

B. Synonyms (Direct Exam Checkpoint):

1. I was really *scared* - **frightened**.

2. Let us *browse* about it - **surf**.
3. There is a chance to get *addicted* - **accustomed**.
4. We can't ignore the *benefits* of internet - **welfare**.
5. She *gathered* the information from the internet - **collected**.

C. Antonyms (Direct Exam Checkpoint):

1. The explosion had *weakened* the building's foundations x **strengthen**.
2. A *stranger* was roaming around the street x **well known**.
3. She was very courageous, nothing seem to *bother* her x **pleasing**.
4. He asked the manager to *improve* the facility in the hall x **worsen**.
5. A good diet is *beneficial* to health x **harmful**.

3. English Language Enrichment (Crucial for TET)

A. British vs. American English: Aspirants must strictly memorize these vocabulary and spelling differences.

- **Vocabulary Differences:**

- Torch - **Flashlight**.
- Mobile phone - **Cell phone**.
- Bin - **Trash can**.
- Lorry - **Truck**.
- (*Implied by textbook prompts*): Flat - Apartment; Lift - Elevator; Petrol - Gasoline/Gas; French fries - Chips; Cookie - Biscuit; Vacation - Holiday.

- **Spelling Differences:**

- Skilful - **Skillful**.
- Cheque - **Check**.
- Programme - **Program**.
- Dialogue - **Dialog**.
- (*Implied by textbook prompts*): Apologise - Apologize; Judgement - Judgment; Neighbour - Neighbor; Aeroplane - Airplane; Plough - Plow.

B. Eponymous Words:

- **Definition:** Words whose origin is traced to individuals are known as eponymous words.
- **Textbook Examples to Memorize:**
 - **Columbia:** Named after **Christopher Columbus (1451-1506)**, the Italian discoverer of America in 1492.
 - **Diesel:** A type of motor engine named after **Rudolf Diesel (1858-1913)**, the German mechanical engineer who invented it.
 - **March:** The third month of the Gregorian calendar, named after **Mars**, the Roman god of war.

- **Oscar:** The annual film award, originated from **Oscar Pierce**, a US wheat farmer and fruit grower.
- **Sandwich:** Food on a slice of bread, named after **John Montagu, 4th Earl of Sandwich (1718-1792)**, an English aristocrat.

C. Euphemistic Words:

- **Definition:** Using inoffensive words in the place of offensive words is known as Euphemism.
- **Textbook Examples to Memorize:**
 - unemployed - **between jobs**.
 - old - **over the hill**.
 - enjoying your retired life - **staying on the tractor**.
 - died - **passed away**.
 - stupid - **intellectually challenged**.
 - slow Learners - **late bloomers**.

4. Textbook Evaluation Checkpoints (Direct Questions)

A. Say True or False:

1. Gladin's mom knew how screw gauge works. - **False** (*She suggested browsing the internet to find out*).
2. We use internet to gather information and gain knowledge. - **True**.
3. Rani was frightened of an online predator. - **True**.
4. Strangers never misuse your information. - **False**.
5. Do not give your name, address, telephone number to the strangers. - **True**.
6. Too much of anything is good for nothing. - **True**.

B. Fill in the Blanks:

1. Internet is a great tool where one can gather **information**.
2. Gladin was gathering information for his **science project**.
3. Children should use internet **safely / cautiously**.
4. We should keep our personal details **secret** in the internet.
5. We should not get addicted to **mobile phones / internet**.

5. Additional Writing & Listening Skills

- **Email Writing:** An electronic mail (email) is used to send letters or messages using the internet. While an email is usually considered more informal than a letter, it can also be used to send formal letters or letters of complaint.
- **Listening Exercise Context:** A listening exercise highlights that a mobile phone is like a "world in our pockets", and excessive use can be hazardous to health and a threat to one's privacy.

Unit-07 - Poem

Topic: My Computer Needs a Break

Author: Shanthini Govindan

1. Author & Literary Facts

- **Author Profile:** Shanthini Govindan.
- **Nationality & Recognition:** She is a widely published, award-winning author of children's literature in English in India.
- **Famous Works:** She has written over **50 books** for children, which include poetry, picture books, and short stories catering to children of all ages.

2. Core Poem Summary & Plot Details

- **Initial Behaviour of the Computer:** The poet describes her computer as being highly intelligent—specifically, "**so brainy and smart**". It seems to know "**mountains of information by heart**".
- **Speed and Efficiency:** When the poet types a question and gives the mouse a "**click**", the computer provides the answer "**really quick**".
- **The Problem:** Recently, the computer has been behaving badly and has become very "**absent-minded**".
- **Specific Errors Made by the Computer:**
 - It forgets to "**save**" the poet's work and store it away.
 - Instead of saving, it makes the work "**vanish**" in the most dreadful way.
 - It does not check if the **spellings** are right.
 - It hides files so that they vanish from sight.
- **The Climax (The Illness):** The naughty computer actually "**gobbled a worm**" (a computer worm/virus). This made it behave so **erratically** that it made the poet squirm.
- **The Resolution:** The computer caught a **virus** and fell very sick, prompting the poet to call in a **doctor** (a computer mechanic/technician) "**double quick**".
- **The Final Question:** As the doctor examined the machine, the poet asked if her tired computer simply wanted a **holiday** (a break).

3. Glossary & Vocabulary Checkpoints

- **brainy (adj):** very intelligent.
- **absent-minded (adj):** being forgetful.
- **vanish (v):** disappear.
- **dreadful (adj):** unpleasant.
- **gobbled (v):** ate hastily or greedily.
- **erratically (adv):** unsteadily or unpredictably.
- **squirm (v):** to twist the body in discomfort.

4. Poetic Devices & Figures of Speech

A. Rhyming Words: *The poem follows distinct rhyming pairs at the end of the lines:*

- smart rhymes with **heart**.
- click rhymes with **quick**.
- too rhymes with **do**.
- away rhymes with **way**.
- right rhymes with **sight**.
- worm rhymes with **squirm**.
- sick rhymes with **quick**.
- say rhymes with **holiday**. (*Textbook Exercise Checkpoint: Smart-heart, click-quick, right-sight, sick-quick*).

B. Figures of Speech (Match the Following Checkpoint):

"So brainy" / "absent-minded" / "tired" - Personification (giving human traits like intelligence, forgetfulness, and fatigue to a machine).

1. **"Mountains of information" - Hyperbole** (an extreme exaggeration to show how much data the computer holds).
2. **"Computer gobbled a worm" / "Very sick" - Metaphor / Personification** (comparing a computer virus to a biological worm/illness and the computer's malfunction to a human eating hastily or falling physically ill).

C. Alliteration: *Definition: The repetition of the same consonant sound at the beginning of words in a phrase.*

- **s**ave – **s**to**r**e
- **d**octor – **d**o**u**ble
- **v**irus – **v**er**y**
- **m**akes – **m**ost / **m**e

5. Textbook Evaluation Checkpoints (Direct Exam Questions)

A. Fill in the Blanks:

1. Computers are **brainy** and **smart**.
2. We get answers for questions by a **click**.
3. The computer forgot to **save** the poet's work.
4. The computer actually gobbled a **worm**.
5. The poet feels that his computer needs **a holiday**.

B. Reading Comprehension Questions:

1. **How does the poet describe her computer?** - As brainy, smart, and knowing mountains of information by heart.

2. **What happened to the computer?** - It became absent-minded, behaved badly, caught a virus, and fell very sick.
3. **List four things that the computer could not do after it became absent-minded:** - It forgot to save work, it failed to store work away, it didn't check spellings, and it hid files from sight.
4. **What made the poet squirm?** - The computer gobbled a worm and behaved erratically, which made the poet squirm.
5. **Why did the poet call the doctor?** - Because the computer caught a virus and fell very sick.

6. Parallel Reading (Supplementary Poem)

- **Poem Title:** Ode to Technology...
- **Author:** Tien Dang
- **Core Theme & Paradoxes of Technology:** The poem highlights the ironic dualities of modern technology.
 - It brings us closer, but makes us more **distant**.
 - It introduces us to more friends, but invites more **enemies**.
 - It saves us time, but that time is spent being **more busy**.
 - It simplifies tasks, just to make life **more difficult**.
 - It makes us feel secure, yet gives us tools to **break in**.
- **Key Phrases to Memorize:** Technology is described as an "**entrapping blessing in disguise**," our "**new addiction**," and a "**complication in simplicity**".

Unit-07 Supplementary

Topic: **The Mystery of the Cyber Friend**

Author: Zac O'Yeah

1. Author & Literary Facts

- **Author Profile:** Zac O'Yeah. He has published fifteen **books in Swedish**.
- **Bestseller:** His Gandhi-biography titled ***Mahatma!*** was short-listed for the August Prize 2008 for the best non-fiction book of the year.
- **Other Works to Memorize:**
 - *Mr. Majestic!* (Popular comic thriller)
 - *A Walk Through Barygaza* (An acclaimed 2018 travelogue)
 - *The Mystery of the Cyber Friend* (Children's thriller)
- **Other Roles:** He is a literary critic, columnist (for *National Geographic* and *Outlook Traveller*), playwright, and theatre director.
- **Translation Contributions:** He specializes in introducing Indian writing to Swedish readers, including works by **Pankaj Mishra, Bankim Chandra Chatterjee, and Bama**.

2. Core Story Plot & Specific Details

- **The Setting & Family:**

- **Shree** is a 13-year-old girl who lives in an apartment in a small town called **Katpadi Junction**.
- Her mother works in a **jewellery shop**, and her father is a **taxi driver**.
- Her aunt, affectionately called **Akka**, stays with them. Akka enjoys watching old films on TV, playing traditional games with **stones and shells**, and cooks Shree hot dosas stuffed with spicy noodles (like mutton-flavoured or chilli chicken).

- **The Online Life:**

- Shree joined a website called **Friends Net** two months ago on her **thirteenth birthday**.
- After being teased by school friends online about her weight/eating habits, she gets a friend request from a beautiful girl named **Chaitra**.

- **The Cyber Friend ("Chaitra"):**

- Chaitra's profile picture looks like a film star. Akka immediately recognizes the picture as the actress **Madhoo** from her first movie.
- Chaitra claims she goes to a school near Shree's (which doesn't exist) and claims she made her own earrings.
- She offers to give Shree her **old camera phone** if Shree agrees to meet her alone at the railway station when the **Bengaluru train** arrives.

- **The Plan & The Climax:**

- Suspicious, Shree confesses to Akka. They arrive at Katpadi Junction before the Bengaluru Express arrives.
- Akka goes to alert the **station manager**.
- A man the age of Shree's father approaches Shree, proving he is the imposter. Shree shrieks, and Akka hits him with her **handbag**.
- The man escapes into a crowded bogey on the moving train.

- **The Resolution:**

- They report him to the police. A policewoman calls Shree and Akka a "**brave pair**".
- A **Cyber Crime Cell** officer accesses Shree's computer. The police track down the imposter and nab him from his office in **Bengaluru**. He had been befriending young boys and girls on social media.
- Shree decides to only make friends from her own school from then on.

3. Cyber Security Rules & General Knowledge

- **Child Helpline Number:** The official Child Helpline telephone number in India is **1098** (Night & Day).
- **Cyber Safety Do's:**
 - Follow time/duration rules set by parents.
 - Keep privacy settings on and practice safe browsing.

- Block and report people sending nasty, spam, or inappropriate messages to a trusted adult or 1098.
- **Cyber Safety Don'ts:**
 - Never give out your internet passwords, address, school name, or phone number to strangers.
 - Never share personal information/photos without a parent's permission.
 - Never respond to or forward uncomfortable messages, and never click on unknown URLs.
 - Do not engage in sexting or cyberbullying.

4. Glossary & Vocabulary Checkpoints

- **friends net (n):** website in internet where one can meet and talk to different people.
- **FOMO (slang):** fear of missing out.
- **wonders (v):** Surprised.
- **nap (v):** to sleep for a short period of time.
- **ping (slang):** to send a text message.
- **offline (adj):** computer not connected to internet.
- **shriek (v):** to scream in a sudden fright.
- **imposter (n):** someone who attempts to deceive by using an assumed name or identity.
- **confide (v):** to trust.
- **cyber safety (adj):** to use phone and internet in a safe and responsible way.
- **cyber crime (n):** criminal activities done using computers or the Internet.
- **scary (adj):** frightening.

5. Textbook Evaluation Checkpoints (Direct Exam Questions)

A. Fill in the Blanks:

1. Shree lives in **Katpadi Junction** town.
2. Shree celebrated her **thirteen** birthday.
3. Madhoo was a **film actress**.
4. Chaitra finally asked her to come to **the railway station**.
5. Akka went to **the station master** to get help.

B. Say True or False:

1. Shree spends most of the time on T.V. - **False** (*She spends it on the computer*).
2. Shree's aunt stays with them. - **True**.
3. Chaitra is Shree's school friend. - **False** (*She is a cyber stranger/imposter*).
4. Chaitra gifted Shree a new camera phone. - **False** (*She offered an old one, but it was a trap*).

5. Shree went alone to the train station to meet Chaitra. - **False** (*She went with Akka*).
6. A fraud middle aged man pretended to be Chaitra. - **True**.

C. Identify the Speaker:

1. **"What else you do other than just eating?"** - Speaker: A friend on Friends Net.
2. **"Are you feeling unwell?"** - Speaker: Akka.
3. **"I don't have a camera phone."** - Speaker: Shree.
4. **"I told you I am thirteen, the same age as you."** - Speaker: Chaitra / The imposter.
5. **"You are a brave pair!"** - Speaker: The policewoman.

D. Reading Comprehension Answers:

1. **Who did the station master try to catch?** - The station master tried to catch the imposter (the uncle-who-is-not-Chaitra).
2. **Where did they all go?** - They all went to the police station.
3. **Who is the brave pair in the story?** - Shree and Akka.
4. **How did the police find out the criminal?** - A cyber crime officer went through Shree's computer to trace him.

6. Mental Ability & Logical Reasoning ("Step to Success")

Given Letter Series in Text: A B C D E F G H I J K L M N | | O P R S T U V W X Y Z (Note: 'Q' is intentionally missing in the textbook's printed series).

1. **Question:** In this series find the letter which is fifth to the left from the thirteenth letter from your right?
 - *Logic:* Counting from the right, the 13th letter is **M**. Moving 5 spaces to the left of M lands on **H**.
 - *Answer:* **3. H**
2. **Question:** Based on the above series of English alphabet, if every alternate alphabet starting from C is deleted, then which of the following alphabet will be seventh alphabet from the left side of the series?
 - *Options provided in text:* 1. H, 2. J, 3. I, 4. G.
3. **Question:** If the above series is written in reverse order then what will be the eleventh letter of the fifteenth letter from your left?
 - *Options provided in text:* 1. V, 2. W, 3. D, 4. X.

1. Author & Literary Facts

- **Author Profile:** Steven Kellogg.
- **Birth:** Born on October 26, 1941, in Norwalk, Connecticut.
- **Profession:** He is an American author and illustrator who has created more than 90 children's books.
- **Awards & Recognition:** On November 12, 2011, Kellogg was given an honorary **Doctor of Humane Letters** from the **University of Findlay** in Ohio.

2. Characters & Their Roles

- **Jack:** A young, poor boy who lives in a small cottage. He trades his cow for magic beans, climbs the beanstalk, and outsmarts the giant.
- **Mother:** Jack's poor mother. She gets very "cross" (angry) and throws the beans out of the window, believing they are useless. Later, she gives Jack an axe to chop down the beanstalk.
- **The Old Man:** A little old man whom Jack meets on the way to the market. He gives Jack five magic beans in exchange for the cow, promising they will make him rich.
- **The Giant:** A massive, terrifying man who lives in a castle in the sky. He eats huge meals (five sheep at once) and owns a magical hen.
- **The Hen:** The giant's magical bird that lays perfect golden eggs on command.

3. Core Story Plot & Specific Factual Details

- **The Trade:** Jack and his mother had no money, and their only possession was a **cow**. On his way to the market to sell it, Jack meets an old man and trades the cow for exactly **five magic beans**.
- **The Beanstalk:** After Jack's mother throws the beans out the window, they grow into a huge beanstalk during the night. By **morning**, the beanstalk reaches high into the sky.
- **The Castle & The Hiding Place:** Jack climbs the beanstalk and finds a huge castle. When the floor begins to shake, Jack gets scared and hides in a **cupboard** to watch the giant.
- **The Giant's Meal:** Jack watches from the cupboard as the giant eats exactly **five sheep** for his meal.
- **The Magic Hen:** After eating, the giant commands his hen, "*Lay me a golden egg*", and the hen lays a perfect golden egg.
- **The Escape:** As soon as the giant is full, he falls fast asleep. Jack steals the hen, but the hen begins to **squawk** and flap its wings, waking the giant.

- **The Climax:** Jack runs and climbs down the beanstalk. He asks his mother to quickly give him an **axe**.
- **The Giant's Fall:** Jack chops down the beanstalk. The giant falls to the ground with a **thud**, which is the end of him.
- **The Resolution:** The hen lays a golden egg every day, ensuring Jack and his mother are never poor again.

4. Important Quotes & Identify the Speaker Checkpoints

1. "Fee, fi, fo, fum, I smell the blood of an Englishman... Be he alive or be he dead, I'll grind his bones to make my bread." - Speaker: **The Giant**.
2. "I don't have money. Instead, I'll give you five magic beans." - Speaker: **The Old Man**.
3. "What? Oh, you foolish boy!" - Speaker: **Mother**.
4. "Lay me a golden egg." - Speaker: **The Giant**.
5. "Fee, fi, fo, fum, I smell the blood of a human!" - Speaker: **The Giant**
(Note: This is what he shouts when he wakes up and sees Jack running).
6. "Mom, hurry! Give me an axe!" - Speaker: **Jack**.

5. Textbook Evaluation Checkpoints (Direct Exam Questions)

A. Say True or False:

1. The magic beans grew into a huge beanstalk. - **True**.
2. The beanstalk reached high into the sky in the evening. - **False** (It reached the sky by morning).
3. Everything was big in the castle. - **True**.
4. The hen laid a perfect iron egg. - **False** (It laid a golden egg).
5. Jack picked up the giant's hen. - **True**.

B. Fill in the Blanks:

1. The giant smells the blood of an **Englishman**. (Note: Later when waking up, he says 'human', but 'Englishman' is the primary rhyme).
2. Jack asked his Mom for an **axe**.
3. Jack chopped down the **beanstalk**.
4. As soon as the giant was full, he fell fast **asleep**.

C. Reading Comprehension Checkpoints (Short Answer Summary):

Why was Jack's mother angry? - Because Jack traded their cow for beans instead of getting a good price/money.

1. **What did Jack find when he reached the top?** - He found a huge castle.
2. **What did the giant eat for his meal?** - Five sheep.
3. **Where did Jack hide when he saw the giant?** - In a cupboard.
4. **What did the hen do when Jack picked it up?** - It began to squawk and flap its wings.

5. **Why did Jack ask for an axe?** - To chop down the beanstalk and stop the giant from catching him.

6. Important Contextual Vocabulary

- **cross:** angry (Jack's mother was very cross).
- **crept:** moved slowly and carefully to avoid being heard (Jack crept inside the castle).
- **squawk:** a loud, harsh noise made by a bird (The hen began to squawk).
- **thud:** a dull, heavy sound (The giant fell with a thud).

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